

Telegram Alerts — Setup Guide

KERALA AYURVEDIC LIFESTYLE · STAFF NOTIFICATIONS & LATEST UPDATES

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Your website can now send an **instant Telegram message to your team** whenever something needs attention — a new booking request, a payment received, or a cancellation. This guide shows you, step by step, how to switch it on by adding your bot token. The second half lists the other new features added in this update.

1. What you'll get

Once set up, your staff Telegram group receives a short message the moment any of these happen:

-  **New booking / consultation request** — so the front desk can approve quickly.
-  **Payment received** — a booking is paid and confirmed.
-  **Cancelled / auto-released** — a booking was cancelled or its unpaid slot reopened.

These alerts are in addition to the emails customers already receive. No customer health details are ever sent to Telegram — only the name, therapy and time.

2. Before you start

YOU NEED	DETAIL
The Telegram app	On a phone or on a computer at web.telegram.org — either works.
Your bot	@bookingkalsbot (“Booking Bot”), already created for you.
The bot token	The secret code BotFather gave you (looks like <code>8693911665:AAE3...</code>). Keep it private.
Website admin login	To open Admin → Settings .

Keep the token secret. Anyone with it can control your bot. Never post it publicly. If it ever leaks, open **BotFather** → **your bot** → **API Token** → **Revoke** to get a new one, then update it in the website.

3. Step-by-step setup

1 Create a Telegram group for your team

Make a new Telegram group (e.g. “**Kerala Bookings**”) and add the staff who should get the alerts.

2 Add the bot to the group

In the group, tap **Add members** and search for **@bookingkalsbot** — add it like any other member.

3 Wake the bot up

In the group, send this exact message: `/start@bookingkalsbot`

This lets the bot “see” the group so the website can find it in the next step.

4 Open the website settings

Log in to your website **Admin**, go to **Settings**, and scroll to the “**Telegram staff alerts**” section.

5 Paste the bot token

In the **Bot token** box, paste the token from BotFather (e.g. `8693911665:AAE3...`).

6 Detect your group

Click **Detect**. The website reads your bot and lists the group(s) that messaged it. Click **your group** to select it — its Chat ID fills in automatically. *(No copying long web links.)*

7 Save

Click **Save Telegram settings**. You’ll see a green “**Connected**” label. That’s it — alerts start arriving straight away.

4. If “Detect” finds nothing

- Make sure you sent `/start@bookingkalsbot` **inside the group** (not to yourself).
- Confirm the bot is actually a member of the group.
- Double-check the token was pasted fully, with no spaces before or after.
- Send the `/start@bookingkalsbot` message once more, then click **Detect** again.

Tip: to test it end to end, make a booking request on the website — a “New request” message should appear in your group within a few seconds.

5. Also new in this update

Alongside Telegram alerts, this update added the following. Everything is already live.

Group bookings — a different therapy per guest NEW

A group booking no longer forces everyone into the same therapy. Each guest can choose their **own therapy**, is matched to their **own same-gender therapist** at the same time, and the group still **pays once** in a single bill. Your staff see each guest as **Name · age · gender · therapy**.

Smarter staff schedule

- **Block reasons show on the schedule** — each blocked slot displays its reason at a glance.
- **Search your blocks** — the Availability list has a search box to find a block by date, time, therapist or reason, so you can remove the right one quickly.
- **Block & unblock right on the schedule** — tap a free 30-minute slot to block it (with a reason), or tap a block to remove it — no separate screen needed.

Customer announcements & closures NEW

From **Front Desk** → **Announcements** you can push a notice to the public website:

- **Closure** (e.g. Deepavali) — shows a “we’re closed on [date]” banner to customers **and** automatically stops bookings on those dates. Remove it and bookings reopen.
- **Message** — a free-text banner (holiday hours, a promotion) that doesn’t affect bookings.

Lead capture — grow your customer list NEW

- A **welcome pop-up** greets first-time visitors and invites them to leave their name, email and phone for exclusive deals (they can dismiss it).
- The **WhatsApp button** now asks for name, phone and email first — so every WhatsApp enquiry becomes a saved contact.
- All captured details appear in **Admin** → **Leads**, with a **Download (Excel)** button.

More reliable payments

The booking payment flow was hardened so a paid booking always confirms — even if a payment notification is delayed or missed, the system re-checks with the payment gateway and confirms automatically, and the status page updates the moment payment lands.